NDB, which announced its first loans in mid-2016, and the Contingent Reserve Arrangement (CRA). At their most recent summit in late 2016, the five countries also announced plans to go forward with a jointly sponsored credit rating agency, arguing that the Western trio of private market actors (Moody's, S&P, and Fitch) had demonstrated both incompetence and bias in failing to warn of the global financial crisis—a point also made by Western analysts.[61]

The fourth and final example of collective financial statecraft constitutes an outside option to reshape the operation of, and thus the politically relevant capability distribution within, global money markets. Each of the members of the BRICS club has, at least rhetorically and to some extent in concrete practice, criticized the dominance of international monetary relations by the U.S. dollar and praised the option of the greater internationalization of China's RMB. The BRICS' decision to pursue this course is particularly noteworthy in that a larger role for the RMB would in many ways complicate international financial policymaking for the other four BRICS, given their individual trade and foreign exchange profiles. Clearly, ongoing international political concerns trumped short-term economic interest.

This study's evaluation of the third question, the motivation of the BRICS for engaging in collective action, leads Chapter 4 to examine the complex mix of motives within each of these five very different emerging powers. All would like greater voice and recognition in global economic governance institutions, as they share common aversions to being instructed by the incumbent powers. Political leaders in Russia, the originator of the BRICS idea as a formal multilateral organization, and in China, the most powerful among the BRICS, are more willing to admit to the ambitions of major powers to have a regional sphere of influence, and they have been the most self-conscious among the BRICS about the advantages of having a BRICS club within the Bretton Woods institutions and the G20. However, working collectively with this diverse BRICS group provides China and Russia an appropriate instrument to convince the global market and suspicious incumbent powers that they do not have a fundamentally revisionist scheme for economic and financial governance; they accept the laws of economics and the concept that markets deserve an important role in their domestic economies and in the world economy.

The three democracies are somewhat less status-aggrieved than Russia and China, and their motives for participation are more mixed. Each would like a greater role in global governance, would like to be viewed as a leader within